

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Storm surge

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

If a storm-surge evacuation order covers you, leave for a safe location outside the surge zone before roads close. Wind strength alone does not describe surge danger. Never walk or drive through coastal floodwater.

Do now.

- ☐ **Check the surge zone**
01 Use your local emergency management evacuation map and official order.
- ☐ **Leave early**
02 Choose an inland destination outside the evacuation area and use designated routes.
- ☐ **Avoid shoreline viewing**
03 Stay away from beaches, seawalls and flooded coastal roads.
- ☐ **If trapped**
04 Contact emergency services with your location and move to a safer higher level without entering a closed attic.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If you live in a surge zone, arrange an inland destination before the storm. Do not wait for public transport that has not been confirmed. Once roads are flooded, do not force a crossing; use the safest elevated location and signal if trapped.

Watch for.

Storm surge may arrive before the worst wind. Do not wait for visible water.

People & practical needs.

Account for children, older people, pets and anyone who needs assistance before moving. Keep shoes, medicines and a torch in the shelter area

Next decision.

Return only after reentry is allowed; damaged bridges, debris and polluted water can remain.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

NWS · Hurricane safety

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/storm-surge/>